T06 Settings.json: Complete Structure

Technical Intermediate

All configuration keys and their scope

File hierarchy

```
~/.claude/settings.json        (global, all projects)
      ↓ overridden by
.claude/settings.json          (project, shared with team)
      ↓ overridden by
.claude/settings.local.json    (local machine, gitignore)
```

Project-local settings override project and user settings. CLI arguments and managed policy have higher priority. Use local settings for personal overrides without Git conflicts.

Complete structure

```
{
  "model": "claude-sonnet-5-5",
  "permissions": {
    "allow": ["Bash(git *)", "Bash(pnpm *)", "Read"],
    "deny":  ["Bash(rm -rf *)", "Write(*.env*)"],
    "ask":   ["Bash(npm publish)"],
    "defaultMode": "acceptEdits",
    "additionalDirectories": ["../shared-libs/"]
  },
  "env": {
    "NODE_ENV": "development",
    "LOG_LEVEL": "debug"
  },
  "statusLine": {
    "type": "command",
    "command": "~/.claude/statusline.sh"
  },
  "outputStyle": "Explanatory",
  "hooks": {
    "PostToolUse": [{
      "matcher": "Edit|Write",
      "hooks": [{ "type": "command",
                  "command": ".claude/hooks/format.sh" }]
    }]
  }
}
```

Available keys

Key	Role
`model`	Default model
`permissions.allow`	Auto-approved tools
`permissions.deny`	Blocked tools
`permissions.ask`	Tools requiring confirmation
`permissions.defaultMode`	Default mode (default/acceptEdits/plan/auto/dontAsk/bypassPermissions)
`permissions` → `additionalDirectories`	Additional accessible directories
`env`	Injected environment variables
`hooks`	Scripts triggered on events
`statusLine`	Custom status line
`outputStyle`	Communication style (Default/Proactive/Concise/Explanatory/Learning)
`spinnerVerbs`	Words in the loading spinner
`spinnerTipsOverride`	Tips displayed during processing
`enableAllProjectMcpServers`	Enables all project MCP servers

Spinner customization

```
{
  "spinnerVerbs": {
    "mode": "replace",
    "verbs": ["Caffeinating...", "Thinking...", "Optimizing..."]
  },
  "spinnerTipsOverride": {
    "tips": ["/compact when context is full"],
    "excludeDefault": true
  }
}
```

`mode: "append"` extends the default list rather than replacing it. These keys have no functional impact, only cosmetic.

What should stay in .gitignore

```
.claude/settings.local.json   # Local machine overrides
CLAUDE.local.md               # Personal project instructions
.env.local                    # Secrets
```

Files to commit (`settings.json`, `agents/`, `skills/`, `hooks/`, `rules/`) represent the shared team configuration. Never include API keys or tokens in these files.